

viable positions in the world. Having acknowledged this, I have taken the reader another step on the psychological journey which leads straight toward compliance with my request. Then comes the request itself—but couched in terms of service which the reader can render, because of his qualifications, to a third party who is worthy of his help.

The closing paragraph tactfully conceals the suggestion that the reader cannot refuse a request which costs him (in those days) a two-cent stamp, especially when he compares himself with those less fortunate. The letter hardly could be laid aside without a feeling of guilt in not replying. After all, the recipient has been appealed to in the name of those who *will read your message, believe in it and be guided by it.*

Not only did the letter bring me valuable answers, but also, with one exception, the men I addressed replied in person. The exception was Theodore Roosevelt, who replied over his secretary's signature. John Wanamaker and Frank A. Vanderlip wrote magnificent replies. William Jennings Bryan and Lord Northcliffe wrote fine letters, and so did others. Moreover, only four of the entire group knew me, so surely the majority of the group did not write to please *me*; they wrote to please themselves, knowing they were about to render a worthy service.

Let me say right here that ten smaller men might have thrown my letter into their wastebaskets. The really big men I have known were notable for their willingness to render service to others. That may be why they were really *big*.

Selling and auto-suggestion. You may not be in the business of selling—but you always sell *yourself*.

You may not believe you have any reason to persuade anybody else of anything—and yet, a good deal of your success and happiness depends upon achieving a reasonable acceptance of your ideas by others. Make a little analysis of your affairs and this will become evident.

You may not see any reason to persuade *yourself* of anything—but it is the very process of self-persuasion which brings on deep subconscious BELIEF and gives you command of life's Supreme Secret.

That is why I began this chapter by talking about enthusiasm. Enthusiasm is the great vehicle of persuasion, whether the persuasion is directed toward another or toward one's self.

Enthusiasm often amounts to automatic auto-suggestion